



The Man Who Sold Nothing But Trust

Ritesh Kumar built a five lakh strong investor following without ever selling a tip, betting that showing his own trades, wins and losses in the open would matter more than any promise of quick returns.

Ritesh Kumar
Founder, Finschool21

India's financial content ecosystem runs on a familiar promise: buy this, sell that, trust me. In 2021, Ritesh Kumar decided to break that formula entirely. Rather than dispensing tips, he began posting his own investment decisions publicly, each one accompanied by the full reasoning behind it, gains and losses alike. There was no sales pitch attached, only a bet that Indian investors, tired of noise, would respond to a chemist's version of honesty applied to markets: show the work, not just the answer.

The bet has scaled into an institution. Finschool21, the SEBI registered research firm Ritesh and Dipika founded on that premise, today serves more than five lakh investors, commands over 368,000 followers across social platforms, and runs a 15,000 strong community with a customer retention rate above 75 percent, a number that would turn heads in any subscription business, let alone one built on financial advice. "We don't run promotions and don't have a

sales team. We have recently launched our academy based on people request", Ritesh has said, describing an approach that runs directly against how most finance influencers built their following.

The credibility has compounded into recognition. Finschool21 was named among Classplus' top three finance educators nationally, featured by TradeFlock as a Fintech Leader for 2025, honoured at the Bharat 2.0 Conclave for Excellence in Digital Finance Education, and profiled by Economic Times Newsmakers in July 2026 for shifting investor conversation away from stock tips altogether. Ritesh has since taken the same argument to a TEDx stage in Faridabad and to lecture halls at Manav Rachna University, GNIOT and IIMT, and the firm carries a Forbes DGEMS 200 nomination for 2026. "Financial literacy isn't about market noise, it's about disciplined thinking that compounds confidence over time," he says, a line that doubles as the firm's entire pitch to a market

saturated with shortcuts.

What began as one man's public trading diary has since branched into an ecosystem. Finschool21 is working on few promising projects in areas like a pre IPO investment desk, an AI research venture called Finstat, and Eqlion, an app built to translate company financials into plain language for retail investors. Finschool21 Global has already opened conversations in Dubai with Singapore, Malaysia and US markets next on the list, an ambitious trajectory for a firm that started as a single video and one follower.

Bootstrapped and profitable throughout, Ritesh has resisted the easier route of scaling through paid promotion, betting instead that transparency compounds the same way good investments do, slowly, then all at once. Whether that bet holds as Finschool21 crosses borders is the next chapter still being written.

www.finschool21.com